

THE EXTERIOR

Careful, efficient detail design is evident everywhere on the S.E.5a, with the emphasis on simplicity, durability, ease of manufacture, and practical serviceability—all vital in getting the aircraft urgently to the frontline and keeping it combat-ready. Early problems with the thin structures of the wing and tail on the S.E.5 were soon ironed out, as was a weakness in the steel-tube undercarriage struts. They were replaced with wooden struts, which were more resilient.

1. Radiator shutters 2. Radiator drain 3. Oil filler 4. Bullet spacer on bracing wires 5. Leather "boots" on bracing-wire ends 6. Perforated exhaust 7. Wing strut end 8. Control pulley inspection panel 9. Control horn 10. Fabric panel join 11. Bungee suspension 12. Gun sight 13. Control-wire grommet 14. Lewis machine gun

